

Finding the real buyer at Walleye Capital

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

8 Walleye contacts in Wave A	1 reply a data center engineer, looking for a new job	0 buying signals in ZoomInfo	312 Chicago phone for Deputy CIO Chris Murphy
STAGE Tier A prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Walleye Capital (Wave A), 8 leads; 3 added Sep 28	LAST TOUCH Sep 29: email 1 to the three Sep 28 adds	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: call Chris Murphy (Deputy CIO)

Bottom line

Lemlist marked Walleye 'Interested', but read the reply: **Henry Hanse, a data center engineer, is job hunting** and asked you about open roles. That is goodwill, not demand, so management should not count Walleye as engaged. Walleye is a 209-person multi-strategy fund headquartered in New York with four offices; the Chicago link is **Chris Murphy (Deputy CIO), who has a 312 number**. The technology leadership above him (CTO Luke Anderson, Deputy CTO Brian Ries) is quant and software, not network. The entry is Chris Murphy, by phone, with a question about how Walleye's Chicago footprint connects to the exchanges.

What Walleye is, in one analogy

A multi-strategy fund is a food hall: several independent kitchens (equities, quant, volatility) sharing one building's plumbing and power. Each kitchen cares about its own recipes; the Core IT team cares about the plumbing. You sell plumbing, so you talk to Core IT, not the chefs.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
No intent, news or scoops for Walleye in the last 10 months (only older 13F trade news)	ZoomInfo	No trigger to cite. This is a relationship play built on a Chicago person, not an event.
Henry Hanse (Data Center Engineer) replied Sep 14-15 asking about roles; offered to 'talk shop' on the customer side of fiber deployments	Lemlist LinkedIn	Not a buyer. But he can explain how Walleye's racks and cross-connects are set up. Keep the door open politely.
Tom Ferlaak promoted to Director of Core IT Services (Jun 2025)	Apollo	HubSpot still lists him as 'IT systems administrator'. He now runs Core IT, so he is a real decision path.
Mei Zhang joined as Chief of Staff, Technology (Nov 2025), ex-Millennium	Apollo	New in seat; chiefs of staff know who owns vendor decisions. Escalation only.
Chris Murphy, Deputy CIO, Chicago phone (312)	Lemlist / Apollo	The only senior technology leader with a visible Chicago tie.

Check first	The Lemlist 'Interested' flag on Henry Hanse and the HubSpot 'replied' timestamp will look like a hot account in any report. Add a HubSpot note saying the reply was a job inquiry so the dashboard isn't misread.
Data notes	Joe Sales, Luis Gonzalez and Kay Gunn have UK or New Jersey numbers; Walleye's network team appears to be split across New York, Minneapolis and London. Confirm whether any network engineer sits in Chicago.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 9-10	Wave A, step 1 + email 1	Visits and 'route diversity after the Zayo + Crown Castle consolidation' to 5 leads	No replies
Sep 14	Wave A, LinkedIn invite	Henry Hanse accepted and asked about job openings	Lead paused
Sep 15	LinkedIn DM (manual)	You clarified you're on the vendor side, offered intros to Rackspace, CDW, AWS partners. Hanse offered to talk shop on fiber deployments.	Goodwill, not demand

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 21-23	Wave A, follow + email 2	'The part of your path map you can't see' to Murphy, Loendorf, Gonzalez, Ferlaak	No replies
Sep 28-29	Wave A, new leads	Kay Gunn, Joe Sales, Michael D'Avolio added; email 1 sent	Too early
Sep 30	CTF ENT Leaders/Practitioners	Duplicates removed	Only in Wave A now

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Chris Murphy	Deputy CIO (HubSpot, Apollo)	Chicago (312)	Senior and Chicago-connected. Best first live conversation.	Wave A, no reply. cmurphy@walleyecapital.com
Tom Ferlaak	Director of Core IT Services since Jun 2025 (Apollo)	Minnesota	Runs the 'plumbing'. HubSpot title is out of date.	Wave A, no reply. tferlaak@walleyecapital.com (verified)
John Loendorf	Head of Information Technology (HubSpot)	n/a	Senior IT owner; peer of Ferlaak.	Wave A, no reply
Luis Gonzalez	Sr Network Engineer (HubSpot)	New Jersey (per phone)	Hands-on network engineer.	Wave A, no reply
Henry Hanse	Data Center Engineer (HubSpot)	n/a	Friendly, knows the racks. Ask for a 10-minute 'how is it set up' chat, nothing more.	Paused. Replied twice on LinkedIn
Mei Zhang	Chief of Staff, Technology since Nov 2025 (Apollo)	New York	Knows who owns what. Escalation only.	Not contacted. mzhang@walleyecapital.com (verified)

Not worth chasing for this goal

CTO Luke Anderson and Deputy CTO Brian Ries come from quant research and software; they won't own carrier decisions. Strategy technology heads (Volatility, Equity Long/Short, Quantic) are trading technologists, not network buyers. Kay Gunn has no title on record; leave her in the sequence untouched.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Chris Murphy Deputy CIO
Why them: Chicago number, senior, untouched by phone.
Channel: Phone Mon Oct 5, voicemail plus email | Subject: Walleye's Chicago paths
Chris, I'm with Crosstown Fiber; we own an underground dark fiber ring in Chicago. I noticed you're Chicago-based. Does Walleye run its own paths to the Chicago exchanges and data centers, or ride a provider's network? If it's the former, I'd like 15 minutes to show you where our conduit runs.
2. Tom Ferlaak Director of Core IT Services
Why them: Congratulate the promotion; ask an ownership question.
Channel: Email, Wed Oct 7 | Subject: Congrats on Core IT, and one question
Tom, congratulations on taking over Core IT Services. Quick question: are carrier and fiber circuits part of your remit, or does that sit with the network team? I own fiber in Chicago and want to make sure I'm talking to the right person, not adding to your inbox.
3. Henry Hanse Data Center Engineer
Why them: Take him up on his offer to talk shop, and keep your promise.
Channel: LinkedIn DM, Tue Oct 6 | Subject: n/a
Henry, I asked around as promised; I'll send you a couple of names this week. Separately, you offered to talk shop: I'd value 10 minutes on how a fund like Walleye thinks about fiber diversity from the customer side. Any time next week work?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Thu Oct 1	Add a HubSpot note: Hanse reply was a job inquiry, not buying interest.	Keeps the management view accurate.
Fri Oct 2	Pause Murphy and Ferlaak in Wave A.	They get personal touches instead.
Mon Oct 5	Call Chris Murphy; voicemail plus email if no answer.	8:30am or 4:30pm CT.
Tue Oct 6	LinkedIn DM to Henry Hanse; send the promised intro names.	Give first; costs nothing.
Wed Oct 7	Email Tom Ferlaak.	Ownership question only.
Mon Oct 12	Second call attempt to Murphy; reply in thread if Ferlaak answered.	-
Mon Oct 19	If silent: email Mei Zhang asking who owns carrier decisions.	One line.
Week of Oct 26	Goal: 15-minute call with Murphy or Ferlaak on Chicago connectivity.	If Walleye has no Chicago network footprint, move to nurture and say so.

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 9	Live conversation with Murphy or reply from Ferlaak	HubSpot call or email logged
Oct 30	Know whether Walleye has a Chicago network need	Qualify in or out; note the answer in HubSpot

Guardrails

- Do not report Walleye as 'Interested' to management until a buyer engages.
- Follow through on the Hanse intros you offered; it's your reputation in a small industry.
- Credits used: 4 Apollo person enrichments; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot contacts and Lemlist-synced notes; Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Walleye Capital (Wave A)' lead activity including Henry Hanse's replies (Sep 14-15); ZoomInfo company profile and news; Apollo people data (Oct 1, 2026).